

time set. This also prevents overheating of the components.

Another option which this soldering station provides is that, it is designed with thermal insulation capability to reduce the transfer of heat to the grip of the iron, allowing one to hold the iron for a longer time.

Based on Curie heat technology. In this type of heating technology, as soon as the power to the soldering station is turned on, the AC signal goes to the handle through a coil, due to which an eddy current is induced in the heater (that is ferromagnetic) to increase its temperature. Now, as soon as the temperature reaches the Curie point, the magnetic properties of the heater change, inducing no further eddy current and turning off the heat. But as soon as the temperature goes below the Curie point, the current is induced again, generating another heating cycle.

Such soldering stations are dependent on the type of heating material used. Today, soldering stations available with this heating facility provide an excellent energy conservation option. Such sta-

Antistatic Soldering/De-Soldering Stations with 'Ultra-Fast Thermal Recovery' Available in India

Brands	Model number	Power consumption	Operating temperature	Price*
Antrix	SLD 938	70W	200-480°C	₹ 12,500
Agronic	AGRONIC-936	60W	160-480°C	₹ 12,000
ERSA	I-CON PICO	80W	150-450°C	₹ 18,281
Goot	RX-711AS	65 W	200-480°C	₹ 11,200
Hakko	FX 838	150W	200-500°C	₹ 75,950
Inde	DSSLF120	120W	100-500°C	₹ 21,000
MetroQ	MTQ-917	60W/80W	160-480°C	₹ 14,034
Metcal	MS-500DS	40W	10-40°C	₹ 95,165
Weller	WX2	120W	0-550°C	₹ 61,330

*The price is indicative only; please re-check before buying

tions avoid any temperature overshoot even during the temperature recovery of the tip.

Hybrid S/D stations. S/D stations are said to be hybrid when these use hybrid tools in conjunction with hybrid heating technology that combines infrared (IR) radiation with conventional heating, especially for SMD components. The IR radiation allows the tools to transfer heat to the components homogeneously.

Such stations have exchangeable hybrid adaptors that protect the chips from getting damaged during the heat transfer. These generally have high-power heaters, with wattage of about 200W.

The choices are many with respect to features, but yes we do have some parameters now to guide us. Don't you think the new styles will affect the selection parameters in the days to come? ●

The author is a technical journalist at EFY

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